



Computer Literacy Program 2019 Annual Report

It is a pleasure to report to you that the Computer Literacy Program (CLP) celebrated its **fifteen** years of operation in 2019. Your generous help and continual support enabled CLP to make steady progress in its core mission of *empowering underprivileged rural youths through computer literacy and technology-aided education*. State of our established mechanisms, such as, Computer Literacy Centers (CLCs), Smart Class Rooms (SCRs), Education through Entertainment (EE), and Connect Students around the World (CSAW) is strong. We have taken some new initiatives as well. What follows is a brief overview of the key CLP activities and initiatives.

- ❖ With some new additions, the total number of CLCs at the end of 2019 stands at 269, associated CLCs at 97 and SCRs at 164.
- ❖ These CLCs provided over 120,000 students (~50% female) with basic computer literacy training since the inception of the program. Typically, 60,000 students benefit from multimedia instruction in the SCRs annually.
- ❖ *Education through Entertainment* (EE) enjoyed substantial growth and acceptance in 2019. EE now has 26 content videos covering environment, science, history, health and hygiene, discipline, biography of influential people, safety practices when natural calamities strike, and others. DUDOK, the Anti-Corruption Commission of Bangladesh together with Kite Bangladesh Limited and Gunijan Trust initiated a *Moral Value Education through Entertainment* pilot project. The pilot project first ran in a cluster of 10 schools in Chittagong and involved over 12,000 students. Next it ran in a second cluster of 12 schools in Lalmonirhat and in a third cluster of 18 schools in Thakurgaon. To date, EE project is operational in 80 schools in Bangladesh.)
- ❖ Another notable development is initiation of the *Education through Entertainment Content Competition* in 2019. In the first round of the competition 124 schools participated and 42 of those submitted contents. Second and third rounds of the competition to select winners from the submitted contents were held in November and December of 2019. The final round and award ceremony are to be held in Dhaka on January 18, 2020. Award winning contents will be added to the EE Content library.
- ❖ The *Connect Students around the World* (CSAW) project had a successful third year. CSAW aims to establish communication (sometimes live through Skype) between students in rural

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Bangladesh and students in US (and potentially other countries) through joint projects to foster cultural exchange, build communication, self-confidence and global exposure. Students from William Annin Middle School (WAMS) in Baskin Ridge, New Jersey, USA and Uddipon Badar-Shamsu Bidya Niketon (UBSBN) in Chaitali, Bagerhat, Bangladesh participated in a project on *Climate Change due to Global Warming*. Some other schools have expressed interest in the program, and we are hopeful that more schools will adopt the project.

- ❖ Maintenance and sustenance of the established CLCs and SCRs is a major cost for the program. Even when the sponsor cost shares, the program has to come up with 50% of the funding required to provide full support for a CLC and/or a SCR. During this operation year CLP provided full maintenance to 70 CLCs for which respective sponsors participated in cost sharing arrangement. Remote monitoring and technical guidance was provided to remaining 269 CLCs and 164 SCRs without cost sharing. Hardware in quite a few of the earlier established centers required replacement. The program delivered 09 desktop and 05 laptop computers this year to the CLCs covered under the maintenance plan. We seek your support for maintenance of these CLCs and SCRs.
- ❖ Celebrated 15 years of achievement (2004-2019) in a lively CLP Annual Event on August 3, 2019 at Rutgers University Center, NJ, USA.
- ❖ CLP has taken steps to engage young volunteers in decision making. The young volunteers are now involved in revamping the CLP website, initiating social media presence and planning the 2020 Annual Event.
- ❖ The new *initiatives and activities* that are planned to be launched include the following.
 - *Presidential Volunteer Service Award* (PVSA) has been introduced to formally recognize the outstanding services provided by young volunteers. Awards will be in three achievement levels (Gold, Silver and Bronze) and two age groups 11-15 years and 16-25 years. 2019 PVSA Gold medal winner is Kean Saadi for his remarkable distant teaching efforts.
 - A web-based Citizen Education Platform, *esocietybd*, has been adopted as a CLP project. Initiated by ATM Kamruzzaman and patronized by CLP, DUDOK and Gunijan, the goal of the project is to build awareness among citizens about important social issues through short online courses, video clips and articles.
 - *Distant Teaching* is becoming popular among CLP volunteers. Several members are enthusiastically participating in real time classroom teaching across the oceans via Skype and enjoying it. So find a school in your galaxy and CLP will be happy to recommend and help set up the technology!

Mark your calendar!

2020 CLP Annual Event is tentatively scheduled for **Saturday, July 25, 2020** at Rutgers Cook College Student Center, New Brunswick. *Please save the date*. We will provide further details as we get closer to the date. We look forward to your presence in the event.

CLP Seeks your continued support

CLP sincerely appreciates your support and donations to continue its activities. *Your sustained support and generous contributions* are crucial to the overall success of the program. Please visit www.clpweb.org for more detailed information on our program.

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CLP wishes you, your family and friends a happy, healthy and prosperous New Year 2020.